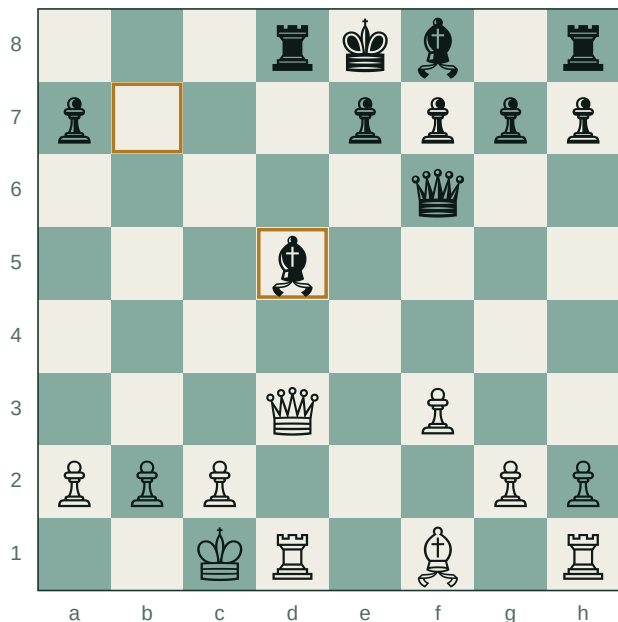


Discovered attacks: White, move 14

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 13...Bxd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

14. Qb5+ Bc6 15. Rxd8+ Kxd8 16. Qb8+

14.Qb5+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From b5 it attacks king on e8 and bishop on d5. Recorded reply: **14...Bc6**.

15.Rxd8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on d8. Recorded reply: **15...Kxd8**.

16.Qb8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -2 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8. Check for tactical protection.